Narrated Accessibility Walk

Brigham and Women’s Hospital (75 Francis St), Boston, MA: from Brigham Circle station, the hospital entrances, and on foot across the Longwood Medical Area to the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus Emergency entrance

Pilot report 6 | Recorded October 28, 2026
Part of an independent series of narrated walks that check whether people with disabilities can reach clinical research sites. Prepared by Uri Kartoun, PhD, Founder, DBbun LLC, Cambridge, MA | uri.kartoun@dbbun.com | dbbun.com

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Summary

A narrated walk from Brigham Circle station on the Green Line to the main entrance of Brigham and Women’s Hospital at 75 Francis St, then on foot across the Longwood Medical Area following the “Emergency” signs to the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus, and back to the station. Following the Emergency signs was a test of wayfinding; research visits usually take place in clinics, which a later walk should include. The Longwood Medical Area is one of the densest clusters of research hospitals in the country: 325 recruiting studies list a Brigham and Women’s site in Boston (ClinicalTrials.gov snapshot of October 4, 2026). This is also the first walk planned from the open-data screen, run the day before.

- **41 items recorded:** 32 with a possible barrier (4 rated high or moderate–high), 6 positive features and 3 notes. Several barrier items also record what worked.
- **The most serious barriers are at crossings.** At the all-way stop at Francis St and Binney St, most drivers did not stop at the stop signs and stopped only when people were already crossing; at least two drove on while people were crossing. It was filmed three times over an hour, and city records list 3 pedestrian crashes there (C15). In front of the Brigham Emergency entrance, a sunken rut of about 2 to 3 inches runs between the warning pad and the crosswalk (D18).

- **Finding the way is hard.** Emergency signs for different hospitals point different ways (E25); inside Brigham, signs to the Emergency Department stop after the main door (G39); and on the way back the walker could not tell which is the inbound platform (toward Park Street) (A4).
- **Two hospital entrances, two ways of managing the curb.** At the Brigham main entrance the covered drop-off was busy but staff directed traffic (D16, D17). At the Beth Israel Deaconess West Emergency entrance, a van was parked on the sidewalk and unattended cars left a single lane (F35).
- **Small, cheap fixes:** a missing screw on a push button (F33), a sign for a push button that isn't there (E23), signs hidden by a pipe and a decoration (F34), rusted button posts (D19).
- **Positives:** a covered drop-off with a warning strip along the whole curb, push-button doors at all main entrances, wheelchairs available outside the Brigham main entrance and the Beth Israel Deaconess West Emergency entrance, benches, an audio next-train sign at the station.
- **Scope:** one walker who does not use a mobility aid, mainly outdoors. The walker also walked through Brigham's public lobby areas; no video or photos were taken inside. Section G lists those observations.

Disclaimer. This report was produced with the help of AI tools (automatic speech transcription and AI-assisted image analysis; see "How this report was produced") and was reviewed by the author. Errors and omissions are possible. Items are possible barriers observed on one day, not legal compliance determinations or findings of violation. Times, counts and distances are estimates. Observations reflect conditions on October 28, 2026 and may have changed since. People and vehicles are not identified: faces, license plates and company names are blurred. This is an independent project; it is not affiliated with or endorsed by any hospital, the City of Boston or the MBTA.

Key findings in photos

The four priority findings (High and Moderate–High); more photos follow at the end of the report. Faces, license plates and company names are blurred.



Figure 1. The sunken rut between the warning pad and the crosswalk in front of the Brigham and Women's Emergency entrance, 75 Francis St (item D18).



Figure 2. The all-way stop at Francis St and Binney St, where most drivers did not stop at the stop signs (item C15).

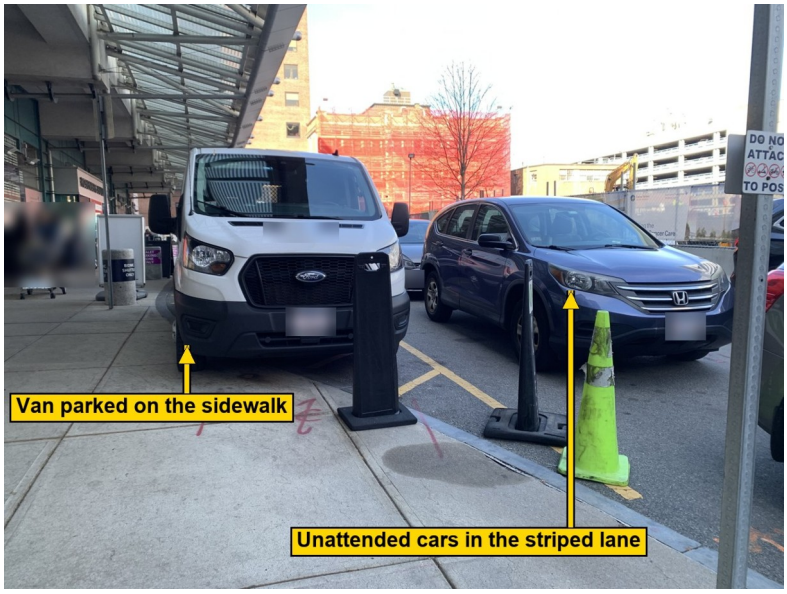


Figure 3. At the Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance: a service van parked on the sidewalk and unattended cars in the striped curb lane (item F35).



Figure 4. Faded crosswalk paint and patched asphalt at a busy junction near the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus (item E28).

Walk details

Date	October 28, 2026 (Wednesday), 10:30 am to about 12:15 pm, sunny and dry
Recordings	Five narrated videos (about 57 minutes in all, the longest 23 minutes), voice notes, 14 photos
Route	Brigham Circle station → Francis St → Brigham and Women's main entrance and Emergency entrance (75 Francis St) → Francis St and Binney St → Longwood Ave and Brookline Ave → Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus, Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance → back along Francis St to Brigham Circle
Narrator	Uri Kartoun, PhD (DBbun LLC); assessed the route from the point of view of wheelchair, walker and cane users, blind and low-vision people, and people who tire easily. The walker does not use a mobility aid.
Why this site	Brigham and Women's is a large academic medical center that runs many clinical studies; the Longwood Medical Area around it holds several other research hospitals. The Green Line E branch is the main rail link to the area.
Planning	The route was screened from open data the day before (city ramp and sidewalk inventories, 311 reports, crashes, OpenStreetMap, elevation, MBTA). The screen gave a list of things to check on site.

What travelers would meet

What each group of travelers would likely meet, based on what the walker observed. These are not test results: no traveler with these disabilities made the trip, so each cell notes what was seen and, where it matters, what remains uncertain.

Traveler	Getting there on foot from the station	At the entrances	Main obstacles
Wheelchair (manual or power)	Seen: a wide Francis St sidewalk; a narrow platform (A6); a sunken rut at the Emergency crosswalk (D18). Uncertain: the four flagged ramps and the elevator route at Park Street	Seen: a covered, managed drop-off at Brigham (D16, D17); at Beth Israel Deaconess West, one lane left by unattended cars and a van on the sidewalk (F35)	D18, C15, F35
Walker, rollator or cane	Seen: no benches on Francis St (B7); uneven brick (B11)	Seen: benches at the Brigham main entrance and the Beth Israel Deaconess West Emergency entrance (D22, F32)	B7, D18
Blind or low vision	Seen: drivers not stopping at the all-way stop (C15); no street-name signs (E27); audio next-train sign (positive, A5)	Seen: warning strips along the Brigham curb (positive); signs hidden by a pipe and a decoration (F34); Emergency signs that stop (G39)	C15, E25, G39
People who tire easily	Seen: an hour on transit (A1); 2 minutes lost finding the platform (A4); no benches on Francis St (B7)	Seen: benches, cafés and seating at the entrances (positive); 10 minutes spent looking for the Emergency Department inside (G39)	A1, A4, G39

Testing the open-data screen

For the first time, the open-data screen was run before the walk and used to plan it. The table compares what it predicted with what was seen. Its distance was corrected before the walk: the routing had looped around a block at the end, and Google Maps gave 0.2 mile (about 300 m).

What the screen predicted	What the walk found	Result
Route about 300 m (corrected from 628 m)	Walked: "not a long walk… only a few minutes"	Consistent (not measured)
No mapped seats on the route	No benches on Francis St; benches at the station and the entrances	Confirmed
4 curb ramps on Francis St rated not compliant with the state access code (ratings from 2008)	Ramps described as "not perfect", but accessible; not checked one by one	Not confirmed (not checked)
One stretch with an 8.8% slope	No slope noted; not measured	Not checked
5 pedestrian crashes near the route (2015–2026); 3 more at the Francis St / Binney St junction, just past the end of the route	Drivers not stopping at that junction's all-way stop (C15)	Consistent (the data do not show the cause)
Hospital drop-off and entrances: not in the data	The sunken rut at the Emergency crosswalk, the drop-offs, push-button problems, signs, vehicles on sidewalks	Missed by the screen (expected)

As on earlier walks, the screen confirmed the long stretch without seats, but it could not see the things that mattered most: how drivers behave at a crossing, the condition of the curb at a hospital entrance, the drop-off, and the signs.

Findings

Severity notes appear in the barrier column; "positive" marks features that worked well. Conf. (confidence): H = seen and recorded on video or photo (sizes and counts are still estimates unless stated); M = described in the narration only, or seen once and not measured. Items are numbered 1 to 41 and cited with their section letter (for example, C15). Severity: ratings in brackets mark the priority items (High, Moderate–High) and Moderate items; items without a rating are Low.

A. Transit and Brigham Circle station

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
1	Trip from Davis to Brigham Circle	About one hour on transit (note)	Red Line to Park Street, then the Green Line E branch: about one hour door to platform, including a wait of about 10 minutes for the Green Line, for a final walk of about 300 m. The walker used the stairs at Park Street; the elevator route was not checked and would likely add time.	People with energy-limiting conditions; wheelchair users (longer step-free transfer)	M	Study teams: count travel time, not distance; offer ride or parking support

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
2	Brigham Circle, arriving	Signs to the hospital (positive)	A Brigham and Women's Hospital sign at 15 Francis St, at the corner of Huntington Ave, and signs to the Longwood area are visible on leaving the platform.	-	M	-
3	Huntington Ave crossings at Brigham Circle	Push buttons and warning pads (positive)	Push buttons at the crossings and yellow warning pads at the curb ramps. The walk phase was not timed.	-	H	-
4	Brigham Circle, going back	Hard to find the right platform (Moderate)	On the way back the walker could not tell where the station entrance was or which is the inbound platform (toward Park Street), and hesitated for about 2 minutes ("it's really confusing"). Reaching the platform means crossing the street; one of the crossings has no traffic light.	First-time visitors, people with cognitive disabilities, low vision; anyone with limited energy (extra walking)	H	Signs at street level showing the inbound and outbound platforms; a signal or marked crossing to the platform
5	Brigham Circle platform	Audio sign, warning strip, benches (positive); unclear alerts	Warning strip along the platform edge, a "Press for audio" next-train sign, benches and fare information. The sign showed "3 current alerts" for the Green Line without saying what they were.	Everyone (unclear alerts)	H	Show the alert text, or a short summary
6	Brigham Circle platform	Narrow platform	The platform is very tight between the track edge and the wall. A device for wheelchair boarding stands on the platform, with limited space around it.	Wheelchair, walker, strollers	M	MBTA: check clear widths around the boarding device

B. Francis St and nearby streets

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
7	Francis St, from Huntington Ave to the hospital	Wide sidewalk, no benches	A wide, well-kept sidewalk ("the wheelchair can go"), but no benches on this stretch.	People who need to rest	H	Add a bench or two along Francis St
8	Francis St near Vining St	Crossing blocked by stopped cars (Moderate)	Stopped and parked cars blocked the crossing ("hard to cross… kind of dangerous"); a driver reversed and turned without regard for people crossing.	Wheelchair, blind and low vision	M	No-stopping signs near the crossing; enforcement

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
9	Francis St curb ramps	Ramps generally usable	The walker found the ramps on Francis St "not perfect" but accessible. The four ramps flagged in city data were not checked one by one.	-	M	Check the four flagged ramps on a later walk
10	Near the garage on Francis St	Cars parked on the sidewalk	Very busy; cars parked on the sidewalk.	Wheelchair, blind and low vision	M	Enforcement; bollards
11	Brick sidewalk by the Longwood area and mental health center signs	Uneven brick and a lot of litter	Uneven brick, and cardboard, a trash bag, cups and paper in the tree pits and on the sidewalk.	Blind and low vision (debris underfoot), wheelchair (brick)	H	Street cleaning; reset the brick
12	Sidewalk by Dana-Farber	Cracked panels; outdoor seating (positive)	Cracked sidewalk panels; outdoor tables and umbrellas.	Wheelchair, walker	H	Replace cracked panels
13	Stairs to a hospital entrance on Francis St	Rust-stained stairs and handrails (note)	Stairs with handrails, both heavily stained with rust ("very dirty and rusty").	People using the stairs; first impression of the site	H	Clean and repaint
14	Garage by the ambulatory care center	Steep garage ramp	A garage ramp described as "really, really steep", made for cars.	Wheelchair, walker (if used as a path)	M	Signed step-free pedestrian route to the garage elevators

C. Francis St at Binney St

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
15	Francis St at Binney St, by the Shapiro Cardiovascular Center	Drivers not stopping at an all-way stop (High)	An all-way stop (four stop signs, wide zebra crosswalks, no traffic light), filmed three times over about an hour. In about 6 minutes of counting, about 16 of about 23 vehicles did not stop at the stop signs (count from the narration). Most drivers stopped only when people were already crossing ("only when there are pedestrians crossing, only then people are stopping"), but at least two drove on while people were crossing, and a medical-area shuttle did not stop. Boston crash records list 3 pedestrian crashes at this junction (2020, 2023, 2023). A nearby sign reads "Do not block intersection, $150 fine", which may encourage drivers to keep moving. The "All way" plates are worn.	Blind and low vision (no signal to cue on), wheelchair users, slow walkers	H	City: traffic signal or raised crosswalks; enforcement; replace the worn plates

D. Brigham and Women's Hospital entrances

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
16	Main entrance drop-off, 75 Francis St	Covered drop-off with a continuous warning strip (positive)	A covered drop-off, protected from rain and snow, with a wide level sidewalk, bollards and a tactile warning strip along the whole curb edge.	-	H	-
17	Main entrance drop-off	Busy curb, but managed	About 8 cars queued at the curb, with private SUVs and a hotel shuttle; staff in red jackets and cones directing traffic.	Wheelchair users arriving by van (space to lower a ramp)	H	Keep a marked space for wheelchair vans
18	Crosswalk in front of the Emergency entrance, 75 Francis St	Sunken rut between the warning pad and the crosswalk (High)	The asphalt has broken and sunk along the curb, leaving a rut the walker estimates at 2 to 3 inches (for scale: the 2010 ADA Standards allow changes in level of only ¼ to ½ inch without a ramp; cited for scale, not as a compliance finding), right where blind people stop at the warning pad ("imagine how it would be in the snow and when it rains").	Wheelchair (casters), walker, cane; blind people at the warning pad	H	Patch the asphalt flush with the curb

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
19	Shapiro Cardiovascular Center, 70 Francis St	Push-button door next to the revolving door; rusted post	An automatic door with a push button beside the revolving door (positive), but the button post is badly rusted and the building number is coming off. The button was not tested.	Wheelchair (if the button fails)	H	Repaint or replace the post; test the button
20	70 Francis St, side entrance	Stairs; rusted accessible door	Stairs to an entrance, with an accessible door and push button nearby, also rusted.	Wheelchair	M	Maintenance
21	Hospital entrance on Francis St	Sensor door and seating (positive)	A sensor-operated door, a bench, tables and chairs.	-	M	-
22	Main entrance, outside	Push button, benches, wheelchairs (positive); dirty glass; cars on the sidewalk	Automatic sliding door and a push button to enter; benches by the exits; a large Emergency sign; two wheelchairs available. The glass was very dirty, and cars were parked on the sidewalk.	Wheelchair, blind and low vision (cars on the sidewalk)	H	Keep the sidewalk clear of parked cars

E. On foot to the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
23	Building near a garage drive, Longwood	Sign for a push button that isn't there	A door signed "Push Button to Open Door" with an arrow, but no button was found ("that's a wrong sign").	Wheelchair users, people who can't open heavy doors	M	Install the button or correct the sign
24	Street by a hospital loading area	Delivery truck working from the sidewalk	A delivery truck stopped at the curb with a hand truck working on the sidewalk, narrowing it; a shuttle had to swing almost into the other lane.	Wheelchair, walker, blind (unexpected obstacle)	H	Off-street loading or timed loading zones
25	Longwood Ave	Emergency signs pointing different ways	Several "Emergency" signs for different hospitals point in different directions ("not clear what emergency").	People in a hurry, people with cognitive disabilities, low vision, visitors	M	Name the hospital on every Emergency sign
26	Path toward the Longwood Galleria	Slightly steep path	"Relatively accessible", but "a little bit steep" for a wheelchair.	Wheelchair	M	Check the slope
27	Crossing in Longwood	No street-name signs seen	No street-name signs were seen at a crossing; only "Emergency West Campus" signs.	Blind and low vision travelers using directions, visitors	M	Add street-name signs

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
28	Busy junction near the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus	No signal, potholes, faded crosswalk (Moderate–High)	No traffic lights at a very busy junction; many potholes and patches, faded crosswalk paint and barricades; the walker had to pick a way across between moving cars.	Wheelchair, walker, blind and low vision	H	City: repaint the crosswalks, repair the surface, review traffic control
29	Crossing to the Beth Israel Deaconess West Emergency drop-off	Warning pads and yield sign (positive); worn markings	Yellow warning pads at both curb ramps and a "yield to pedestrians" sign in the street, but worn crosswalk paint and cracked asphalt; a construction site beside the approach.	Low vision	H	Repaint the crosswalk
30	Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus	Signs, benches, accessible parking (positive); construction everywhere	Signs to the Emergency Department, an "Accessible pedestrian passage" sign, benches, accessible parking and new pavement in places; construction barriers and scaffolding on many paths.	Wheelchair, blind and low vision (routes change)	H	Signed accessible detours around the construction
31	A building on the West Campus	Door with steps; ramp to another door	One door at the top of steps; a nearby ramp with railings leads to an accessible door, but no push button was seen there.	Wheelchair, walker	H	Push button at the ramp door

F. Beth Israel Deaconess West, Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
32	Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance	Push button, signs, wheelchair available, benches (positive)	A push-to-open button on the railing, accessible-entrance and "Push to enter" signs, a clear Emergency sign, a wheelchair left outside for patients, long benches, and metal guard posts in front of the doors that protect them from wheelchair bumps.	-	H	-
33	Same entrance, push button	Missing screw on the push button	The button works (tested by the walker), but one of its two mounting screws is missing, and it is the only button for the middle doors.	Wheelchair users (if the plate works loose)	H	Replace the screw (a two-minute fix)
34	Same entrance, signs	Signs hidden by a pipe and a decoration	A no-smoking sign is mounted directly behind a vertical pipe and can be read in full only from the side; another is half covered by a seasonal corn-stalk decoration.	Low vision; anyone who can't move around to read a sign	H	Move the signs; check sign placement at entrances

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
35	Same entrance, curb	Van on the sidewalk; unattended cars leave one lane (Moderate–High)	A service van parked with its wheels up on the sidewalk by the door, next to a "Shuttle" sign; in the striped lane beside it, cars left with no drivers, leaving one lane for every vehicle to get out (drop-offs, wheelchair vans, ambulances). Seen at about 11:33 from a bench (a car with hazard lights blocking a lane; a security officer moving a car on) and again at 11:46–11:48 (the photos): the curb was blocked for at least 15 minutes.	Wheelchair users arriving or leaving by vehicle; blind and low vision (obstacle at the door); ambulances	H	Keep the curb lane clear; enforcement; a marked wheelchair-van space
36	Same entrance, nearby	Bicycles by the walking path; construction noise	Bicycles parked against the wall near the path; construction noise at the entrance.	Blind and low vision (cane users); people sensitive to noise	M	Move bicycle parking away from the path

G. Inside Brigham and Women's public areas

Observations only, from walking through the public lobby areas; no video or photos were taken inside.

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
37	Inside, near the 75 Francis St entrance	Automatic doors with no sign	Sliding doors open by sensor, but nothing says so; the walker wasn't sure how to open them.	Blind and low vision, first-time visitors	M	"Automatic door" sign
38	Inside, main entrance and lobby	Push-button doors, restrooms, escalator stop buttons, map (positive)	Push-button and large sliding doors; a stroller and a wheelchair user moving freely; restrooms; emergency stop buttons on the escalators; an information desk and a campus map; an accessible bridge over Francis St with doors held open.	-	M	-
39	Inside: finding the Emergency Department	Signs to the Emergency Department stop (Moderate)	One Emergency sign at the main door, then no further signs seen; the elevator directory lists the Emergency Department on floor 1 but gives no directions. The walker could not find it for about 10 minutes ("it shows a sign to the emergency and it disappears").	People in a hurry, people with cognitive disabilities, low vision, visitors	M	Continuous signs from every entrance to the Emergency Department

#	Where	Possible barrier or feature	Observation	Most affected	Conf.	Suggested fix
40	Inside, a side exit	Confusing exit with manual doors	An "Employees only" sign right next to the exit sign, so visitors may think the exit is closed to them; a manual sliding door and a second door, neither with a push button; the exit is closed at night and on weekends.	Wheelchair users; everyone (confusing signs)	M	Clear sign wording; push-button doors
41	Inside, lobby	Card-only staff door	A card-operated staff door with no push button; staff who use wheelchairs may need an opener (not tested).	Staff who use wheelchairs	M	Automatic opener

Evidence for key findings

Where each key finding can be checked in the recordings. The recordings are kept by the author and are not published, because they show faces and license plates; excerpts with faces and plates blurred are available on request to the hospitals and the City.

#	Finding	Where to find it (file, time)
C15	Drivers not stopping at the all-way stop	Video IMG_6513, 1:05–3:04; video IMG_6511, 9:02–15:01 (the count, from the narration); video IMG_6528, 3:09–4:57. Figure 2.
D18	Sunken rut at the Emergency crosswalk	Video IMG_6511, 5:13–5:44. Figure 1.
E28	Junction near the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus	Video IMG_6513, 16:45–17:33. Figure 4.
F35	Van on the sidewalk; unattended cars in the curb lane	Photos IMG_6525 to IMG_6527; audio from a bench nearby, 0:45–2:11. Figure 3.
G39	Signs to the Emergency Department stop inside	Walker's notes; about 10 minutes spent looking for the Emergency Department.
A4	Hard to find the right platform (Moderate)	Video IMG_6529, 4:31–6:41.
E23	Sign for a push button that isn't there	Video IMG_6513, 3:50–4:11. Figure 5.

Questions for the hospitals, the city and the MBTA

- City of Boston: could the Francis St / Binney St junction (C15) get a traffic signal, raised crosswalks or enforcement, and could the "Do not block intersection" sign be reviewed alongside the stop signs?
- City of Boston or the hospital: could the sunken rut at the Brigham Emergency crosswalk (D18) be patched flush with the curb before winter?
- Beth Israel Deaconess: could the curb lane at the Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance be kept clear of unattended cars, with a marked wheelchair-van space (F35)?
- Brigham and Women's: could signs to the Emergency Department continue from the main door all the way to it (G39), and could the side-exit signs be made clear (G40)?
- City of Boston: could the busy junction near the Beth Israel Deaconess West Campus (E28) get repainted crosswalks, surface repairs and a review of traffic control?

- Longwood hospitals together: could every "Emergency" sign name its hospital (E25)?
- MBTA: could Brigham Circle show inbound and outbound platforms at street level (A4), and could next-train signs give the text of current alerts (A5)?
- Study teams: do participants with disabilities get directions that include the station, the crossing at Francis St and Binney St, the drop-off and the way inside?

Checking the AI-assisted analysis

The item list was drafted with AI help from the transcribed narration, the face-blurred frames and the photos, and reviewed by the walker. The review found and corrected several errors: the AI first described the push button at Beth Israel Deaconess West as intact (one screw is missing), missed the sign hidden behind a pipe, and said the walkway by that entrance was clear (a van was parked on the sidewalk). The walker had noticed all three on site. The AI also first took the junction at Francis St and Binney St for an uncontrolled crossing; the frames show stop signs on every approach, so the item was reframed as drivers not obeying an all-way stop. The vehicle count at that junction comes from the narration and should be checked against the video. License plates, faces and a company name were blurred by hand in the figures.

More photo evidence

More photos and video frames; faces, license plates and company names are blurred.



Figure 5. A door signed "Push Button to Open Door", with no button found nearby (item E23).



Figure 6. The push button at the Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance: it works, but one of its two mounting screws is missing (item F33).



Figure 7. A sign at the Rosenberg Building Emergency entrance mounted directly behind a vertical pipe (item F34).



Figure 8. The covered main drop-off at Brigham and Women's, with a tactile warning strip along the whole curb (item D16).

How this report was produced

- **Capture:** five narrated smartphone videos, voice notes and 14 photos made by the author.
- **Local processing on the author's computer:** audio extracted with ffmpeg 7.1 (via imageio-ffmpeg 0.6.0); narration transcribed with faster-whisper, model medium.en, on a local GPU; one frame sampled every 3 seconds; faces blurred with OpenCV 4.14 before any image left the computer; license plates, faces and company names blurred by hand in the figures.
- **Open-data screen:** a Python script using Boston's Pedestrian Ramp and Sidewalk inventories, Boston 311, Boston crash records and resident safety concerns, Boston Public Works work zones, OpenStreetMap, USGS elevation, the MBTA API and ClinicalTrials.gov.
- **AI review:** the blurred frames, the photos and the transcripts were reviewed by Claude (Anthropic), model claude-opus-5-5, which drafted the item list and this report. The author reviewed the findings and corrected several of them (see "Checking the AI-assisted analysis").
- **Limitations:** one walker on one dry morning; walk-signal timing and the bus stop were planned but not checked; the four flagged ramps were not checked one by one; the interior was seen only in passing; counts and distances are estimates; items are possible barriers, not legal compliance determinations. The items have not yet been reviewed by people with disabilities; feedback on the checklist is being collected separately, so this is a preliminary assessment.